

Cost per task, not cost per token

ONE APPROVED COMMENTARY · ILLUSTRATIVE

Token cost

one draft at list prices



≈ US\$0.11

With regenerations

× 2.5 drafts, plus judge calls



≈ US\$0.30 well under a dollar

Reviewer time

the real cost driver

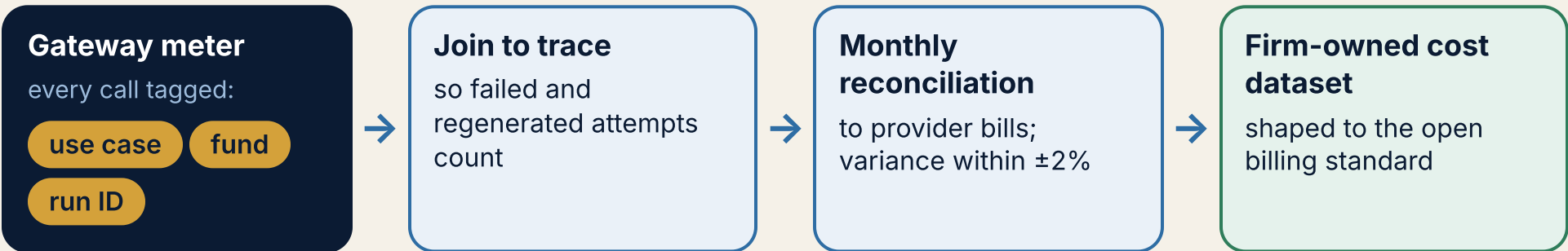
much larger: not to scale

THE SIGNAL TO REPORT

Cost per approved output, alongside the regeneration rate

counting every failed and regenerated draft; a cheaper token that needs three retries and a longer review is not cheaper

HOW IT IS MEASURED



BUDGETS NEED TEETH

"A budget without a quota is a number, not a control"

FinOps Foundation. Pair every cap with an enforcement point that fails closed, so a runaway agent loop stops itself.